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Introduction

Comprehension in competitive exams is about quickly and correctly understanding complicated information. This means being able to pick out the main points, figure out meanings that aren't directly stated, and notice small differences in texts or data. To do well in comprehension, you need to be good at pulling out important details, putting information together, and thinking logically to answer questions or solve problems within the time given. It's not just about knowing a lot about the topic, but also being able to work with the information smartly, showing that you're prepared for tough academic or work-related tasks.

This Book is designed with a singular purpose: to equip you with strategies, techniques, and practice necessary to master reading comprehension and achieve a good score in SSC, banking and other competitive exams. With the help of this book, aspirants can master the concepts and attempt questions accurately with confidence in their examination.

Some Salient features of this book are :-

1. **Classification of passages** : Passages have been divided into various categories to give us an idea about the kinds of passages that are mostly asked. There is a complete chapter dedicated to each type of passage.
2. **Types of questions** : In this book, we have covered all types of questions that are asked in the reading comprehension section based on the passage.
3. **Grammar Notes** : Important concepts of grammar have been given in this book to help aspirants tackle grammar-based questions.
4. **Concepts With illustrative Examples** : Each topic has been explained clearly with the help of relevant examples to provide a strong foundation of basic concepts.
5. **Time Efficient Strategy for Solving Questions** : This book provides you with the best strategy for solving various types of questions in a time efficient manner.
6. **Plenty of Practice Questions** : There are plenty of questions to practice and improve your reading skill. After solving practice questions, you will have mastered the comprehension skills and be able to deal with such questions without any fear or hesitation.
7. **Previous Year Questions** : In this book, we have provided previous year questions of SSC and Banking based on the latest pattern and the availability of question paper.
8. **Clear and Detailed Solutions** : Each question has been answered with clear and detailed solutions to ensure ease of understanding.

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General Solving Approach

General Strategy for Solving Reading Comprehension :-

1. Preview the Passage:

Start by quickly scanning the passage to grasp its main idea, structure, and any highlighted points. This helps in setting the context before diving into the details.

2. Read Actively:

Engage with the passage actively. While reading, focus on understanding the author's tone, style, and the relationships between ideas. Take note of keywords, transitions, and any patterns.

3. Identify Main Ideas:

Determine the central theme and main ideas of the passage. Understanding the core message helps in answering questions that require an overall comprehension of the text.

4. Analyze Paragraph Structure:

Pay attention to the structure of each paragraph. Look for topic sentences, supporting details, and concluding remarks. This aids in comprehending the flow of ideas.

5. Take Brief Notes:

Jot down concise notes summarizing each paragraph. This can include key points, relationships between ideas, or any information that stands out. These notes serve as a quick reference.

6. Understand Vocabulary in Context:

If you encounter unfamiliar words, try to understand them in the context of the passage. Consider how they contribute to the overall meaning.

7. Answer Direct Questions First:

Start with questions that have direct answers in the passage. This ensures you secure points for factual information before delving into more interpretative questions.

8. Use Process of Elimination:

For multiple-choice questions, eliminate obviously incorrect choices to increase the likelihood of selecting the correct answer, even if you're unsure.

9. Manage Time Effectively:

Allocate specific time intervals for reading the passage and answering questions. If a question is particularly challenging, move on and return to it later.

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Types of Questions

Various types of questions are asked from reading comprehension in competitive exams. Each type of question tests a different skill of the reader. Here, we are going to cover some of the main types.

1. **Fact or Detail Based**
2. **Title of the passage**
3. **Central Idea or Theme**
4. **Structure of the passage**
5. **Tone of the passage**
6. **Inference Based**
7. **Summary**
8. **Grammar Based**

Now, we are going to deal with each type individually and state the approach for solving them.

1. Fact or Detail Based : These questions intend to ask about a specific fact or detail from the passage. Keywords are: what, how, where, when, etc. This type also covers **Correct or Incorrect** statement/s; **True or False** statement/s.

How to Solve : Look for the keyword or phrase in the passage. These questions are generally straightforward and do not require extensive reading of the passage. However, some questions might have twisted facts, which demand careful examination of the text.

Example 1

Honeybees, despite their diminutive size, play a crucial role in our ecosystem. They pollinate over 75% of the world's flowering plants, contributing to the growth of fruits, vegetables, and crops vital for human food security. A single hive houses tens of thousands of bees, each with a specialized role to ensure the colony's survival. Honeycomb, a marvel of geometric efficiency, stores the nectar bees collect, transforming it into honey—a delicious natural sweetener and valuable medicinal resource.

Question.1. Approximately what percentage of the world's flowering plants are pollinated by honeybees?

- (a) less than 75 percent
- (b) over 75 percent
- (c) 70 percent
- (d) can not be determined from the passage

Solution.1.(b) over 75 percent.

It is mentioned in the 2nd line of the passage that honeybees pollinate over 75% of the world's flowering plants.

(Line from the passage: They pollinate over 75% of the world's flowering plants, contributing to the growth of fruits, vegetables, and crops vital for human food security.)

Question.2. According to the passage, what is not the role of a honeycomb?

- (a) collecting the nectar from flowers
- (b) pollinating plants
- (c) providing shelter to bees
- (d) storing nectar

Solution.2.(a) collecting nectar from flowers.

The passage mentions that the bees collect nectar and store it in the hive. Later, they transform this nectar into honey. But, option (a) states that honeycomb collects the nectar from flowers. Therefore, option (a) does not state the role of honeycomb. Hence, option (a) is the most appropriate answer.

Question.3. Which of the following statements is true according to the passage?

- (a) Honeybees play an insignificant role in the ecosystem.
- (b) Honey is a natural sweetener that does not have any medicinal properties.
- (c) A single hive houses tens of hundreds of bees.
- (d) Pollination by honeybees contributes to the growth of fruits, vegetables and crops.

Solution.3.(d) Pollination by honeybees contributes to the growth of fruits, vegetables and crops.

It is mentioned in the 2nd line of the passage that pollination of the world's flowering plants contributes to the growth of fruits, vegetables and plants.

(Line/s from the passage- They pollinate over 75% of the world's flowering plants, contributing to the growth of fruits, vegetables, and crops vital for human food security.)

Example 2

Despite their small size, crows boast impressive intelligence. Scientists compare their cognitive abilities to those of a seven-year-old child. These brainy birds create and use tools, solve complex puzzles, and possess remarkable memories, recognizing faces for years

and exhibiting social behaviors like remembering past interactions and forming complex social structures. Their intelligence allows them to thrive in diverse environments, making them skilled problem solvers and adept social navigators. So, the next time you encounter a crow, remember, you're not just looking at a bird, but a highly intelligent creature worthy of respect.

Question.1. What is the basis for scientists comparing the cognitive abilities of crows to those of a seven-year-old child?

- (a) Size of their brain
- (b) Ability to mimic human speech
- (c) Tool creation and puzzle-solving skills
- (d) Speed of flight

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Solution.1.(c) Tool creation and puzzle-solving skills.

It is mentioned in the initial lines of the passage that the scientists compare the intelligence of crows to that of a seven year olds on the basis of their ability to create and use tools, solve puzzles and their remarkable memory. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate answer.

Question.2. Which of the following behaviors demonstrates the remarkable memory of crows ?

- (a) Ability to camouflage in their surroundings
- (b) Recognizing faces for years
- (c) Singing complex melodies
- (d) Building intricate nests

Solution.2.(b) Recognizing faces for years.

The passage mentions that crows can recognise faces for years and exhibit social behavior like remembering past interactions and forming complex social structures. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

Question.3. What contributes to the intelligence of crows, enabling them to thrive in diverse environments?

- (a) Exceptional sense of smell
- (b) Infrared vision
- (c) Skilled problem-solving abilities
- (d) Ability to fly long distances without resting

Solution.3.(c) Skilled problem-solving abilities.

It is given in the passage that the intelligence of crows allows them to thrive in diverse environments. Crows are skilled problem solvers and adept social navigators.

2. Title Based : Title is the most suitable heading for a passage. It is a short phrase that captures the essence of the passage. Title is different from the main idea or theme.

How to find : Skim through the passage and identify the main subject or topic that is being discussed or described.

Example 1

Capital punishment, or the death penalty, remains a contentious issue. Supporters argue its deterrent effect on heinous crimes, emphasizing retribution. Critics highlight ethical concerns, citing the irreversible loss of human life and the potential for wrongful executions. Legal challenges question the fairness of trials and the existence of biases. The death penalty's effectiveness as a crime deterrent is debated, with inconclusive evidence. Human rights advocates call for its abolition, emphasizing the right to life. Alternatives, like life imprisonment without parole, are proposed as more humane options. The global trend leans toward reducing or abolishing capital punishment. The debate underscores the complex interplay between justice, morality, and the evolving values of society. As we navigate these complexities, the question of whether the death penalty has a rightful place in our legal systems remains a significant and unresolved challenge.

Question. Select the most appropriate title for the passage.

- (a) Abolition of capital punishment
- (b) Capital punishment as a deterrent for heinous crimes
- (c) Ethical considerations of death penalty
- (d) Alternatives to death penalty

Solution.(c) Ethical Considerations of Death penalty

The passage talks about the debate over the death penalty, with some supporting it as a deterrent, while others raise ethical concerns. It emphasizes the complex relationship between justice, morality, and society's values. Hence, option (c) is the most appropriate title for the passage.

Example 2

In the digital age, YouTube plays a central role in our lives, offering entertainment, education, and information. The surge in user-generated content raises concerns about the necessity of regulating the platform. Advocates for regulation highlight potential

harm, especially to vulnerable audiences like children, due to the diverse range of content from educational to explicit material. Inappropriate content, misinformation, and extremist views prompt calls for oversight to maintain a safe space for users, particularly younger ones. Critics stress the urgent need for regulation to counter the spread of misinformation, which can impact public opinion and lead to real-world consequences. Proponents of a hands-off approach argue for the preservation of free speech, fearing that regulation may stifle creativity and diverse opinions. Striking a balance between upholding democratic principles and protecting users poses a complex challenge. The debate extends beyond YouTube, involving broader discussions on the role of government intervention in the digital realm, with advocates for both self-regulation and external oversight.

Question. Select the most appropriate title for the passage.

- (a) YouTube's Evolution: Challenges and Solutions
- (b) Balancing Act: Regulating Content in the Digital Age
- (c) The Dilemma of YouTube: Safety vs. Freedom of Expression
- (d) Navigating the Digital Landscape: Perspectives on YouTube Regulation

Solution.(b) Balancing Act: Regulating Content in the Digital Age.

The passage discusses whether YouTube should be regulated due to concerns about harmful content and misinformation. It explores the challenge of finding a balance between protecting users and allowing free expression in the digital age.

3. Central Idea or Theme : Theme is the underlying message or central idea. It is the essence of what the author wants to convey to the reader.

How to identify: Identify the recurring ideas and concepts in the passage. This involves understanding the broader topic or subject matter.

Example 1

Forest fires wreak havoc on wildlife, leading to the tragic loss of habitats and countless animal lives. Small creatures and larger animals alike face immediate danger as flames engulf their homes. The aftermath reveals scorched landscapes, disrupting ecosystems and triggering a ripple effect through the food chain. Beyond visible casualties, the indirect consequences are profound, compromising the delicate balance of biodiversity. Breeding and nesting grounds are destroyed, further endangering struggling species. Conservation efforts must intertwine with preventing and combating forest fires to protect these critical ecosystems and the diverse life they support. Urgent action is needed to ensure the resilience of our planet's vital lungs.

Question. Identify the central theme of the passage.

- (a) Need for conservation efforts
- (b) Impact of forest fires on wildlife
- (c) Forest fires leading to the loss of biodiversity
- (d) Aftermath of forest fires

Solution.(c) Forest fires leading to the loss of biodiversity.

The passage emphasizes the tragic loss of habitats, animal lives, and the disruption of ecosystems, ultimately leading to the loss of biodiversity.

Example 2

The rapid advancement of artificial intelligence (AI) brings forth a spectrum of possibilities, yet it is not devoid of potential dangers that warrant careful consideration. One prominent concern revolves around job displacement, as AI's automation capabilities may replace certain human roles, leading to unemployment and economic shifts. Moreover, there are apprehensions about the ethical implications of AI, particularly in decision-making processes. Bias in AI algorithms could perpetuate societal inequalities, and the lack of transparency in complex AI systems raises concerns about accountability. Security risks also loom large, as AI can be exploited for malicious purposes, posing threats to privacy and national security. Striking a balance between harnessing AI's potential for innovation while mitigating these risks requires robust regulatory frameworks, ethical guidelines, and ongoing vigilance to ensure the responsible development and deployment of AI technologies in our evolving digital landscape.

Question. Identify the central theme of the passage.

- (a) the Advantages of Artificial Intelligence
- (b) ethical Considerations in AI Development
- (c) the Potential Dangers of AI
- (d) the Role of Job Displacement in AI Evolution

Solution.(c) the Potential Dangers of AI

The central theme of the passage is the potential dangers associated with artificial intelligence involving concerns about job displacement, ethical implications, and security risks. It emphasizes the need for responsible development and regulation to address these challenges in the evolving landscape of AI technology.

4. Structure of the passage : The structure of a passage means how the writer arranges and links different parts to share their message clearly. It includes using different ways or patterns to organize the information, making it easier for readers to follow the flow of ideas and see how different parts of the text relate to each other.

How to identify : While reading the passage, look at the manner in which information is organised and presented.

Some common structures are:

- (a) Cause and Effect
- (b) Compare and Contrast
- (c) Problem and Solution
- (d) Chronological
- (e) Process Writing
- (f) Pragmatic
- (g) Definition

(a) Cause and effect : The cause-and-effect structure of a passage is a way of organizing information where the author explains the relationships between events or actions and their outcomes or consequences. In this structure:

- Cause: The author presents the factors or events that lead to a particular result.
- Effect: The author describes the outcomes or consequences that result from the stated causes.

Example 1

Heavy rainfall over an extended period saturated the soil in the region, causing widespread flooding in low-lying areas. The excessive water levels led to the weakening of foundations, resulting in several homes and structures collapsing. The floodwaters also contaminated drinking water sources, leading to a surge in waterborne illnesses. Emergency services were stretched, and communities faced displacement. This chain of events highlighted the direct correlation between prolonged rainfall, flooding, structural vulnerabilities, and the subsequent health crises in the affected area.

Question. Select the most suitable structure for the above passage.

- (a) Pragmatic
- (b) Cause and Effect
- (c) Compare and contrast
- (d) Chronological

Solution.(b) Cause and effect

The structure of the passage is cause and effect. It mentions heavy rainfall and soil saturation as the cause and the subsequent effects are widespread flooding, structural vulnerabilities, water contamination, health crises, and community displacement. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

(b) Compare and Contrast : The compare-and-contrast structure of a passage is a way of organizing information where the author highlights the similarities and differences between two or more subjects, ideas, concepts, or events.

Example 2

High school and college, while both educational stages, differ significantly in various aspects. In high school, students often follow a structured curriculum, attending classes throughout the day, while college students enjoy more flexibility in scheduling and may have days with fewer classes. Additionally, high school assignments are usually more guided and structured, with teachers providing clear instructions. Conversely, college assignments demand greater independent research and critical thinking. Socially, high school often involves a close-knit community, whereas college fosters a more diverse and independent social environment. Both stages contribute to personal development, but the transition from high school to college requires adapting to increased autonomy and academic responsibility. Understanding these distinctions helps students navigate the unique challenges and opportunities presented by each educational level.

Question. Select the most suitable structure for the above passage.

- (a) Cause and effect
- (b) Definition
- (c) Problem and solution
- (d) Compare and contrast

Solution.(d) Compare and contrast

The structure of the passage is compare and contrast, as it highlights the differences between high school and college in various aspects, such as curriculum structure, assignment expectations, and social environments. Hence, option (d) is the most appropriate answer.

(c) Problem and Solution : The problem-and-solution structure of a passage is a way of organizing information where the author first presents a problem or challenge and then proposes one or more solutions to address or resolve that problem. In this structure:

- Problem: The author introduces and explains the issue or challenge that needs attention or resolution.
- Solution: The author presents one or more solutions or strategies to mitigate or solve the identified problem.

Example 3

The escalating issue of plastic pollution poses a significant threat to the environment. Single-use plastics, such as bottles and bags,

contribute to pollution in oceans and harm marine life. The problem necessitates urgent attention to curb the detrimental effects on ecosystems. One viable solution is the promotion of reusable alternatives and the implementation of stricter regulations on single-use plastic production. By encouraging the use of eco-friendly materials and recycling initiatives, communities can reduce their environmental impact. Additionally, educational campaigns can raise awareness about the consequences of plastic pollution, fostering a collective commitment to sustainable practices. This combination of regulatory measures, consumer choices, and public awareness campaigns constitutes a comprehensive approach to mitigating the challenges posed by plastic pollution and preserving the health of our planet.

Question. Select the most suitable structure for the above passage.

- (a) Cause and effect
- (b) Definition
- (c) Problem and solution
- (d) Compare and contrast

Solution.(c) Problem and solution

The structure of the passage is problem and solution. It highlights the issue of plastic pollution and proposes solutions such as promoting reusable alternatives, implementing stricter regulations, and conducting educational campaigns (solution). Hence, option (d) is the most appropriate answer.

(d) Chronological : The chronological structure of a passage is a way of organizing information in the order in which events or actions occurred over time. In this structure:

- Chronological Order: Information is presented sequentially, following a timeline or a specific order of events.

Example 4

In 1776, the Declaration of Independence marked a pivotal moment in American history. Following its adoption, the Revolutionary War erupted, and colonists engaged in a struggle for independence from British rule. Over the next few years, iconic events unfolded, including the signing of the Treaty of Paris in 1783, officially ending the war and recognizing the United States as an independent nation. The drafting of the U.S. Constitution in 1787 established the framework for the new government. The 19th century witnessed westward expansion, the Civil War, and the Emancipation Proclamation, shaping the nation's identity. Advancements such as the Industrial Revolution and the abolitionist movement further transformed American society. By the 20th century, significant events like World Wars I and II, the Civil Rights Movement, and technological innovations continued to shape the historical narrative, creating a rich tapestry of events that define the American experience.

Question. Select the most suitable structure for the above passage.

- (a) Cause and effect
- (b) Chronological
- (c) Problem and solution
- (d) Compare and contrast

Solution.(b) Chronological

The structure of the passage is chronological, as it presents historical events in the order in which they occurred over time, spanning from the Declaration of Independence in 1776 to the 20th century. Hence, option (b) is the most appropriate answer.

(e) Process writing : Process writing is a type of organizational structure where the author explains or describes a series of steps or stages in a particular sequence. The purpose is to provide a clear and detailed explanation of how something is done.

Example 5

Baking chocolate chip cookies is a delightful process that brings joy to many. Start by preheating the oven to 350°F. In a large bowl, cream together softened butter, brown sugar, and granulated sugar until smooth. Beat in eggs, one at a time, then add vanilla extract. In a separate bowl, whisk together flour, baking soda, and salt. Gradually add the dry ingredients to the wet mixture, stirring until well combined. Fold in chocolate chips. Using a cookie scoop, drop rounded dough onto a baking sheet. Bake for 10-12 minutes or until edges are golden. Allow cookies to cool on a wire rack. This straightforward process ensures a batch of delicious, homemade chocolate chip cookies ready to be enjoyed with a glass of milk.

Question. Select the most suitable structure for the above passage.

- (a) Cause and effect
- (b) Definition
- (c) Process writing
- (d) Compare and contrast

Solution.(b) Process writing

The structure of the passage is process writing, as it provides a step-by-step explanation of the process of baking chocolate chip cookies.

(f) Pragmatic : In a pragmatic structure, things are dealt in a way that is based on practical rather than theoretical considerations.

Example 6

In workplace communication, clarity is crucial for effective collaboration. When conveying information, choosing precise and unambiguous language helps avoid misunderstandings. Email communication should be concise, with a clear subject line and a focused message. During meetings, participants benefit from actively listening and seeking clarification when needed. Additionally, adapting communication styles to the audience ensures that information resonates appropriately. In negotiations, finding common ground and employing compromise fosters positive outcomes. Pragmatic communication acknowledges the importance of context, emphasizing practicality and efficiency in conveying messages. By prioritizing clarity and understanding the dynamics of communication, individuals can navigate professional interactions successfully, contributing to a more productive and harmonious work environment.

Question. Select the most suitable structure for the above passage.

- (a) Pragmatic
- (b) Definition
- (c) Process writing
- (d) Compare and contrast

Solution.(a) Pragmatic

The structure of the passage is pragmatic, as it emphasizes the importance of clarity in workplace communication and provides practical advice for effective interactions, considering the context and efficiency of conveying messages.

(g) Definition : The definition structure of a passage is a way of organizing information where the author provides a clear and precise explanation of the meaning, characteristics, or significance of a particular term, concept, or idea.

Example 7

Empathy, often considered a cornerstone of human connection, refers to the ability to understand and share the feelings of another. It involves not only recognizing someone else's emotions but also experiencing a sense of compassion and connection. Empathy goes beyond sympathy, as it requires an active effort to grasp the perspectives and emotions of others. This emotional intelligence enables individuals to navigate social interactions, build meaningful relationships, and offer support in times of need. In essence, empathy serves as a bridge that fosters understanding and connection among people, contributing to a more compassionate and harmonious society.

Question. Select the most suitable structure for the above passage.

- (a) Pragmatic
- (b) Definition
- (c) Process writing
- (d) Compare and contrast

Solution.(b) Definition

The structure of the passage is definition, as it explains the meaning and significance of empathy, detailing its key features and highlighting its role in fostering understanding and connection among people.

5. Tone of the passage : The tone of a passage refers to the author's attitude or feeling toward the subject matter. There are various types of tones. Here, we have provided the tones commonly asked in competitive exams.

Humanistic: In the humanistic tone, the author conveys a sense of understanding, respect, and support for people's unique experiences, emotions, and needs.

Critical: A Critical tone often describes a fault-finding attitude of the author; in a negative sense. It may also indicate a deep analysis of an issue with a neutral outlook. (critical- fault finding)

Cynical: The cynical tone is when the author conveys a doubtful nature. He is pessimistic about whether something will happen or whether it is worthwhile.(cynical- distrustful)

Narrative: In a narrative tone, the author is the character himself and tries to convey a story or an event. A narrative type of comprehension often presents situations like an event, dispute, conflicts, problems & solutions, motivational events, etc. Topics like my wedding day or learning to drive a car etc.(narrative- describing)

Descriptive: In a descriptive tone, something is described in detail like a story or an event, or some new product. (Describe- To tell, convey in words the appearance, nature, attributes, etc)

Jovial / Jocular / Humorous: In a Jovial or humorous tone, the author tries to make the context of the passage funny and amusing. He tries to create humour. The humour can be created out of a situation. (Jovial/Jocular/Humorous- Funny)

Sarcastic: In a sarcastic tone, the author tries to convey a meaning that is exactly opposite to the actual meaning. This may be

sometimes confused with humourous, but often sarcasm is used for topics that the author is not much in favor of. (Sarcastic-mocking)

Nostalgic: In a nostalgic tone, the author tries to convey a sense of longing for the past. It can be a good as well as a sad memory. Topics like my first day at school, my wedding, When I won a gold medal, etc.(Nostalgic- remembering the past and getting emotional)

Acerbic / Harsh / Severe / Bitter / Caustic / Vitriolic:

In this tone, the author expresses his dissatisfaction with something or somebody brutally. The author shows his anger or may express his dislike towards a man.

Angry / Indignant: In this tone, the author expresses his anger towards the subject in a justified manner by expressing different reasons that are identified with the issue.

Apologetic: In this tone, the author expresses regret or blame in regard to something that has happened before. Generally, this tone is seen, by and large, discussing opinions identified with world wars, natural disasters events, or other such calamities that have affected humankind adversely. (Apologetic- feeling sorry)

Biased: In this tone, the author favours a certain thing/person/group over the other. The author tends to have a one-sided tone to show his tendency towards it. (biased- Showing favour to one)

Commiserating: This kind of tone is used to express pain or show sensitivity for a man or a gathering of individuals experiencing partial practices or social standards. The writer plans to familiarise the reader with the trauma experienced by the sufferers. (Commiserating- Feeling for others)

Condescending / Patronising: A condescending tone suggests a mentality of patronizing superiority of a specific thing / individual / gathering. Such passages may show snobbish or contemptuous tones with respect to things considered inferior in the author's point of view.

Grandiose: This type of tone is adopted in a descriptive style and something is shown in a very grand way. The passage may appear more elaborate than necessary. Also, sometimes abstract passages utilize a grandiose style of writing. (Grandiose- Showing as too great)

Introspective: This type of tone is used when one would talk about analyzing one's feelings or contemplating one's actions. An introspective tone is used in the passage to self-examine and reflects upon one's actions and feelings. (Introspective- examining one's own thoughts and feelings)

Incendiary/ provocative: We have all read some famous speeches by great orators and found their words moving. That is an incendiary tone. It's the tone of speech that is also utilized by revolutionaries and politicians. It is a provocative tone intended to affect individuals in a negative or positive course.

Laudatory: A commendatory tone commends and appreciates somebody or something. This is generally used for a person we respect. (Laud- praise)

Pedestrian: When a passage looks neither interesting nor complex to the reader, probably it has a pedestrian tone of writing. In other words, this kind of tone is used in the passage that talks about commonplace, things, and ideas.

Populist: A populist tone is used to discuss theories and characteristics shown by the general public. The author of the passage uses a populist tone to explain the features and behaviour of common people. (Populist- People)

Sarcastic / Satirical / Ironical / Taunting: The author uses this tone to express his dislike indirectly and without sounding too serious. In this tone, the author expresses a negative feeling about something in an insulting or unexpected way.

Speculative: In a speculative tone, the author explores possibilities or potential outcomes without stating definite conclusions. Election trends and opinion polls are a common example of this tone. (Speculative- Guessing)

Analytical: In an analytical tone, the author looks at all the facts and reasons about a topic and explains them in a clear and organized way.

Reflective: In a reflective tone, the author thinks about their past and shares what they've learned from it, showing how they've gained wisdom over time.

Inspirational: Inspirational tone is meant to motivate, encourage, and stimulate the reader. It often suggests a sense of admiration and respect for the topic or person being discussed. This involves looking at the positive side of things, encouraging readers, and offering hope.

Informative: An informative tone is a style of writing or speaking that conveys information in a clear, factual, and objective manner. The

primary purpose is to impart knowledge or share facts.

Didactic: This tone is used to teach people something, especially a moral lesson.

Example 1

The sun set low, turning the town's streets golden. Old shops with hand-painted signs told stories of a time when things were easy. The smell of fresh bread floated from the bakery, still standing strong.

Walking by the old cinema, the sign blinked, promising classic movies. It made me think of times spent in the dim theater, sharing secrets. The town square, once lively with music, now stood quiet, remembering days of fun.

The cobblestone paths spoke of adventures taken with every step. The fading sunlight painted a picture of the past, capturing the feeling of a town where time left its mark on everything.

Question. Identify the tone of the passage.

- (a) Informative
- (b) Sarcastic
- (c) Nostalgic
- (d) Introspective

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Solution.(c) Nostalgic

The passage feels like looking back with a sense of missing the old times and memories. It's not trying to give facts or make fun; it's more about feeling sentimental and nostalgic.

Example 2

In a magical world, where time felt like a never-ending story, there lived a special person named Luna. She wore a long, flowing robe made of sparkling starlight and walked with gentle steps on the border between dreams and reality.

Luna had eyes that seemed to know everything, like colorful windows into the past and future. Every time she looked around, it was as if a beautiful dance of creation unfolded, showing the birth of new things and the patterns of the universe. When she gazed, even the stars in the sky and the galaxies in space seemed to bow down, recognizing the amazing power within her.

Her footsteps left behind a trail of glittering stardust, marking her journey through the vastness of the cosmos. Whenever Luna reached out her hand, it was like the stars themselves gathered around, creating pictures and stories in the night sky, telling the tale of her adventures.

Luna was like a queen of grace, shining brightly in the darkness, showing everyone the way forward. Her voice was like a sweet song that traveled through the air, echoing in the corners of time. Everything in the sky, from the moon to the planets, seemed to cheer for her, acknowledging how special she was.

In this incredible world, Luna danced on the edge of forever, leaving behind a magical trace that affected everything around her. She was like the director of a fantastic play, making sure each part of the universe played its role in the grand story of existence. And in her company, even the vast universe itself seemed to say, "You are truly amazing."

Question. Identify the tone of the passage.

- (a) Acerbic
- (b) Grandiose
- (c) Laudatory
- (d) Sarcastic

Solution.(b) Grandiose

In this passage, the author talks about a magical world with a special person named Luna. Luna, wearing a sparkling starlight robe, is described as someone who has a deep connection with the universe. The writing uses grand words to show how impressive and important Luna is in this enchanting place.

Example 3

Once upon a time, in a small village nestled between rolling hills and meandering streams, lived a young girl named Maya. Despite facing numerous challenges, Maya embraced each day with a heart full of hope and a spirit that refused to be dampened.

Maya's days began before the sun painted the sky with its golden hues. With determination in her eyes, she toiled in the family garden, nurturing tiny seeds into vibrant blossoms. Her hands, though calloused, cradled dreams that reached for the heavens.

As the seasons changed, so did Maya's aspirations. She yearned for knowledge and embarked on a journey to the village school. Every step was a testament to her resilience, and every lesson learned echoed the melody of possibilities.

In the face of adversity, Maya discovered the strength within. She became a beacon of inspiration for the village, showing that courage and perseverance could overcome any obstacle. Her story became a living testament to the transformative power of hope and hard work.

Word of Maya's unwavering spirit spread far beyond the village. People from distant lands marveled at the girl who turned challenges into stepping stones. Maya's journey became a source of inspiration for those who dared to dream.

In the end, Maya not only transformed her own life but also became the catalyst for positive change in her community. Her inspirational tale whispered through the winds of time, reminding everyone that with a heart full of hope and a resilient spirit, one could turn dreams into reality.

Question. Identify the tone of the passage.

- (a) Informative
- (b) Reflective
- (c) Speculative
- (d) Inspirational

Solution.(d) Inspirational

This passage is about a girl who faces challenges but stays hopeful and works hard. Her story inspires others to believe in their dreams and work with courage. It's a positive message about the strength of hope and determination.

6. Inference : An inference is a logical interpretation or conclusion that is not explicitly stated in the text. It involves using information from the passage, along with your own background knowledge and reasoning skills, to make an educated guess about something that is not explicitly mentioned. (Explicit- stated clearly)

How to make sure that the inference is correct

- Support your inference with evidence from the passage.
- Ensure your inference aligns with the overall context and purpose of the text.
- Be cautious about making assumptions without clear support in the text.
- Consider alternative interpretations and acknowledge any ambiguity.
- Double-check specific language and details in the passage.
- Look for additional details in the passage that either support or contradict your inference.

Example 1

Digitalization has become a transformative force in India, reshaping various sectors and propelling the nation towards a tech-savvy future. In governance, the implementation of e-governance has streamlined processes, minimized bureaucracy, and increased transparency, offering citizens seamless access to government services.

Economically, the rise of digital payment systems, e-commerce platforms, and online marketplaces has fostered entrepreneurship and expanded market reach. Small businesses have flourished, aided by digital inclusion initiatives that connect rural communities to broader economic opportunities.

The education landscape has witnessed a revolution with the advent of e-learning platforms, online courses, and digital classrooms. This digital shift has democratized education, making quality learning accessible to students irrespective of their geographical location.

In healthcare, digital technologies have improved accessibility and patient care. Telemedicine services have flourished, particularly in remote areas, ensuring healthcare reaches even the most underserved populations. Health information systems have enhanced data management, leading to improved public health planning and response.

While India's digital transformation brings numerous benefits, challenges like digital literacy, cybersecurity, and equitable access must be addressed. Nevertheless, the ongoing integration of digital technologies positions India as a global leader in the digital era, marking a significant societal shift towards a more connected and technologically advanced nation.

Question. Which of the following inferences can be drawn from the above passage?

- (a) The implementation of e-governance in India has led to increased bureaucratic inefficiencies and reduced transparency.
- (b) Digitalization in India has primarily impacted the healthcare sector, leading to improved patient care and accessibility.
- (c) The rise of digital payment systems and online marketplaces has hindered the growth of small businesses in India.
- (d) Challenges such as digital literacy, cybersecurity, and equitable access to technology need to be addressed for India's successful digital transformation.

Solution.(d) Challenges such as digital literacy, cybersecurity, and equitable access to technology need to be addressed for India's successful digital transformation.

The passage highlights India's positive digital transformation across governance, economy, education, and healthcare. The challenges of digital literacy, cybersecurity, and equitable access are acknowledged, emphasizing their importance in ensuring the success of India's ongoing digital evolution.

Example 2

Illegal enclosures for wild animals pose a grave threat to biodiversity and animal welfare. In various parts of the world, unscrupulous individuals engage in capturing and confining wild animals for commercial gain or personal amusement. These activities not only disrupt ecosystems but also subject the animals to inhumane conditions. Such illegal enclosures contribute to the depletion of wildlife populations, disrupt natural habitats, and often result in the mistreatment of these creatures. Efforts to combat this issue require a combination of strengthened law enforcement, public awareness, and international cooperation to protect the well-being and conservation of wild species.

Question. Which of the following inferences can be drawn from the above passage?

- (a) Illegal enclosures for wild animals contribute positively to biodiversity.
- (b) Combating illegal enclosures requires a combination of strengthened law enforcement, public awareness, and international cooperation.
- (c) The mistreatment of wild animals in illegal enclosures has no impact on biodiversity or ecosystems.
- (d) Unscrupulous individuals engaging in capturing wild animals primarily do so for conservation purposes.

Solution.(b) Combating illegal enclosures requires a combination of strengthened law enforcement, public awareness, and international cooperation.

The passage emphasizes that combating the issue of illegal enclosures for wild animals requires a multifaceted approach involving strengthened law enforcement, public awareness, and international cooperation.

7. Summary : Summary is like a short version of a story or article. It takes the important information and puts it together in a way that's shorter and easier to understand. Instead of reading the whole thing, you can get the main ideas from the summary.

How to find the summary of a passage

- Identify the main ideas and important details in the passage. Look for key concepts, arguments, or events.
- Pay attention to the introduction and conclusion paragraphs, as they often contain the main theme or message of the passage.
- Consider why the author wrote the passage. Understanding the purpose can help you pinpoint the central message.
- Remove unnecessary details, examples, or supporting information. Focus on the core elements that drive the passage's main point.
- Practice summarizing different types of passages regularly. This skill improves with practice, and summarizing various texts will enhance your ability to extract essential information.

Example 1

The soaring prices of medicines have become a pressing concern, posing a significant challenge to healthcare accessibility. In many regions, the cost of essential medications has reached unprecedented levels, placing a financial burden on individuals and straining healthcare systems. The consequences are particularly severe for those without adequate insurance or financial means, as they may face difficult choices between purchasing essential medications and meeting other basic needs. The high prices of medicines not only impact individual well-being but also contribute to broader issues of health inequality. Addressing this challenge requires a multifaceted approach, involving regulatory measures, increased transparency in pricing, and efforts to promote generic alternatives. Ensuring affordable access to vital medications is crucial for building a healthcare system that prioritizes the well-being of all individuals, regardless of their economic circumstances.

Question. Select the best summary of the passage.

- (a) Health inequality is not influenced by the high prices of medicines.
- (b) The financial burden caused by soaring medicine prices primarily affects individuals with adequate insurance.
- (c) There is a need for regulatory measures and transparency to deal with the soaring prices of medicines.
- (d) Addressing health inequality can be achieved solely by promoting generic alternatives to essential medications.

Solution.(c) There is a need for regulatory measures and transparency to deal with the soaring prices of medicines.

The passage highlights that high medicine prices are a problem, and solutions like regulations and transparency are needed to address it.

Example 2

The rise of tensions among nations worldwide, fueled by conflicts with neighboring countries, casts a shadow over global stability. Ongoing territorial disputes and geopolitical rivalries have escalated into more profound concerns, impacting diplomatic relations and regional harmony. The ripple effects of these tensions extend beyond borders, affecting economies, security, and international cooperation. As nations grapple with the complexities of historical grievances and strategic interests, the specter of war looms large, creating an atmosphere of uncertainty and unease. The urgent need for diplomatic dialogue and conflict resolution mechanisms becomes evident, emphasizing the crucial role of international cooperation in fostering peace and mitigating the potential consequences of heightened tensions.

Question. Select the best summary of the passage.

- (a) Ongoing territorial disputes and geopolitical rivalries are impacting diplomatic relations and regional harmony.
- (b) The rise of tensions among nations worldwide is fueling conflicts with neighboring countries, creating a shadow over global stability.
- (c) The specter of war looms large, creating an atmosphere of uncertainty and unease, emphasizing the urgent need for diplomatic dialogue and conflict resolution mechanisms.
- (d) the crucial role of international cooperation in fostering peace and mitigating the potential consequences of heightened tensions.

Solution.(d) The crucial role of international cooperation in fostering peace and mitigating the potential consequences of heightened tensions.

The given passage states that it is really important for countries to work together to make peace and avoid problems when tensions rise. It emphasizes the urgent need for nations to talk diplomatically and collaborate globally to keep the world stable, especially when facing conflicts and geopolitical issues.

8. Grammar Based : These questions are based on the concepts of English grammar. For example:- Parts of speech, Types of Sentences, Active/Passive Voice, Tense, Types of Phrases, Types of Clauses, etc. This topic has been covered in detail in the chapter **Grammar Concepts**.

Grammar Concepts

In this chapter, we have covered all the important topics of grammar from which Eduquity has asked questions in the comprehension.

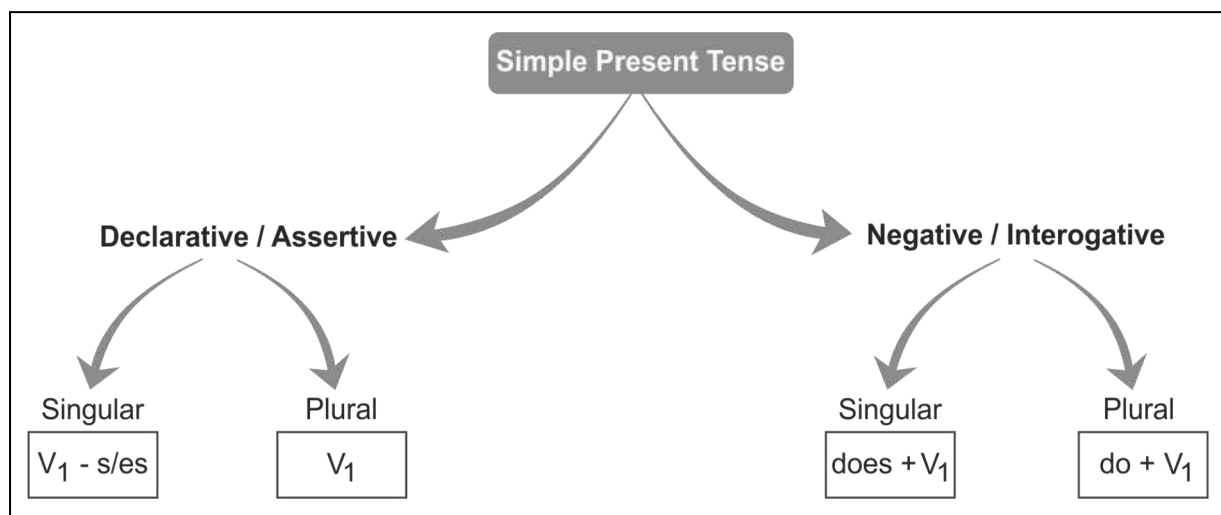
- Tense & Voice
- Types of Sentences Based on Function
- Types of Clauses
- Types of Sentences Based on Structure
- Connectors
- Types of Phrases
- Parts of Speech

Tense & Voice

	Tense	Active Voice	Passive Voice
Present	Simple Present	V_1 / (V_1 -s/es) do/does + V_1	is/am/are + V_3
	Present Continuous	is/am/are + V_{ing}	is/am/are + being + V_3
	Present Perfect	has/have + V_3	has/have + been + V_3
	Present Perfect Continuous	has/have + been + V_{ing}	has/have + been + being + V_3 (Rarely used)
Past	Simple Past	V_2 / (did + V_1)	was/were + V_3
	Past Continuous	was/were + V_{ing}	was/were + being + V_3
	Past Perfect	had + V_3	had + been + V_3
	Past Perfect Continuous	had + been + V_{ing}	had + been + being + V_3 (Rarely used)
Future	Simple Future	will/shall + V_1	will/shall + be + V_3
	Future Continuous	will/shall + be + V_{ing}	will/shall + be + being + V_3 (Rarely used)
	Future Perfect	will/shall + have + V_3	will/shall + have been + V_3
	Future Perfect Continuous	will/shall + have been + V_{ing}	will/shall + have been + being + V_3 (Rarely used)

Note:- Simple Tense is also called Indefinite Tense.

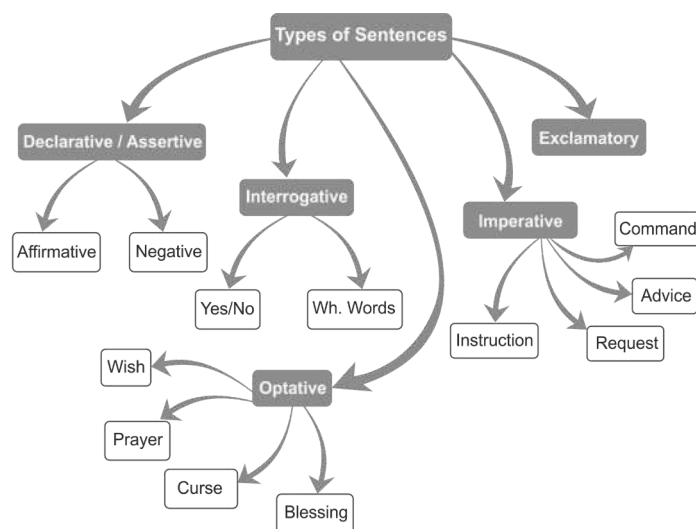
Continuous Tense is also called Progressive Tense.



Special Case of Pronoun 'I'

Present Continuous Tense	I + am + V _{ing}	I am learning French these days.
Past Continuous Tense	I + was + V _{ing}	I was working at 10:00 p.m. last night
All other Tenses	Plural Verb	I prepare my own meals. (Simple Present Tense) I do not concede to your demands. (Simple Present Tense) I have finished my homework. (Present Perfect Tense)

Types of Sentences (Based on function)



There are mainly four types of sentences based on their function such as making a statement or asking a question.

1. Declarative Sentence
2. Interrogative Sentence
3. Imperative Sentence
4. Exclamatory Sentence

1. Declarative Sentence : Used to state facts, provide information, or express an opinion. It ends with a full stop, also known as period (.). These are further divided into two types.

- **Affirmative** : It expresses a positive statement.
E.g.- The Earth revolves around the Sun.
- **Negative** : It expresses a denial or a negative fact.
E.g.- He does not like coffee.

2. Interrogative Sentence : Used to ask a question. These sentences always end with a question mark (?).

- **Yes/No Questions:** Usually start with an auxiliary verb (Is, Are, Do, Have, etc).
E.g.- Do you have the report?
- **Wh- Questions:** Start with question words like Who, What, Where, Why, When, or How.
E.g.- Where are you going?

3. Imperative Sentence : Used to give orders, commands, requests, advice, suggestion, or instructions. These usually end with a full stop (.), but can end with an exclamation mark (!) if the command is forceful. In these sentences, the subject "You" is often understood (hidden).

- Command: Shut the door.
- Request: Please pass the salt.
- Advice: Take your medicine on time.

4. Exclamatory Sentences : Used to express strong emotions such as surprise, joy, anger, or sorrow.

These sentences always end with an exclamation mark (!).

E.g.- What a beautiful day it is!

How wonderful the performance was!

Note:- There is one more type of sentence – Optative Sentence – which is less commonly used.

An **optative sentence** expresses a wish, prayer, blessing, curse, or desire. These sentences follow a variety of structures.

Using May

In these sentences, the auxiliary verb "May" is placed before the subject to indicate a prayer or blessing.

- **May** God bless you!
- **May** you live long!

Using "Wish"

Used to express a desire for something to happen or to be true.

- I **wish** I were a bird!
- I **wish** you a very happy birthday!
- **Wish** you a safe journey!

Using "Long live"

Used to express a collective wish for the longevity of an entity or person.

- Long live the King!
- Long live our revolution!

Using "If" or "Would that"

Used to express strong, often unrealizable, desires.

- **If only** I had known the truth!
- **Would that** he were here today!

Types of Clauses

A **clause** is the fundamental unit of a sentence. It is a group of words that contains both a **subject** and a **predicate** (verb).

There are two main types of clauses:

1. Independent (Main) Clause

An independent clause expresses a complete thought and can stand alone as a sentence.

- **Structure:** Subject + Verb
- **Example:** *The sun set.*
- **Example:** *I like coffee.*

2. Dependent (Subordinate) Clause

A dependent clause contains a subject and a verb but does not express a complete thought. It "depends" on an independent clause to make sense. These usually start with **subordinating conjunctions** (because, although, if, since) or **relative pronouns** (who, which, that).

- **Example:** ...*because it was raining.* (Incomplete)
- **Example:** *Although he was tired...* (Incomplete)

Types of Dependent Clauses

Dependent clauses are categorized based on their role in a sentence. They can act as nouns, adjectives, or adverbs.

(i) **Noun Clause** : A dependent clause that functions as a noun. It can be a subject, an object, or a complement.

- **Example:** **What he said** was true. (Subject)
- **Example:** I don't know **where she lives.** (Object)

(ii) **Adjective (Relative) Clause** : A dependent clause that modifies a noun or pronoun. It usually starts with *who, whom, whose, that, or which*.

- **Example:** The man **who lives next door** is a doctor.
- **Example:** This is the book **that I bought yesterday.**

(iii) **Adverbial Clause** : A dependent clause that modifies a verb, adjective, or another adverb. It tells us *when, where, why, how, or under what condition*.

- **Example:** I will call you **when I arrive.** (When)
- **Example:** He ran **as if his life depended on it.** (How)

Types of Sentences (Based on Structure)

There are four types of sentences based on their structure:

1. Simple Sentence

A simple sentence consists of **one independent clause**. It contains one subject and one predicate.

- **Structure:** [1 Independent Clause]
- **Example:** The cat slept on the rug.
- **Example:** John and Mary **played** and **sang.** (Still a simple sentence because it expresses one complete thought).

2. Compound Sentence

A compound sentence joins **two or more independent clauses** together. These clauses are usually connected by a comma and a **coordinating conjunction** (FANBOYS: *For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So*) or a semicolon.

- **Structure:** [Independent Clause] + [Conjunction] + [Independent Clause]
- **Example:** I cooked dinner, **and** he washed the dishes.
- **Example:** The weather was cold; **however**, we went for a walk.

3. Complex Sentence

A complex sentence contains **one independent clause** and at least **one dependent clause**. The dependent clause usually begins with a **subordinating conjunction** (such as *because, although, if, since, while, when*).

- **Structure:** [Independent Clause] + [Dependent Clause]
- **Example:** We stayed indoors **because it was raining.**
- **Example:** **Although he was tired**, he finished his

homework.

4. Compound-Complex Sentence

As the name suggests, this is a hybrid. It contains **at least two independent clauses** and **at least one dependent clause**.

- **Structure:** [Ind. Clause] + [Ind. Clause] + [Dep. Clause]
- **Example:** I forgot my umbrella, and I got soaked because I didn't check the forecast.
- **Example:** While the music played, she danced, and the crowd cheered.

Connectors

A connector is a word or phrase used to link two words, clauses, or sentences.

1. Coordinating Conjunctions (FANBOYS)

These join two independent clauses of equal grammatical rank. They create Compound Sentences.

F	For	Use: Shows reason (similar to 'because'). E.g.- I believe in him, for he has never lied to me.
A	And	Use: Adds information. E.g.- She finished her homework, and then she went out to play.
N	Nor	Use: Presents a non-contrasting negative idea. E.g.- He doesn't like tea, nor does he enjoy coffee.
B	But	Use: Shows contrast. E.g.- The food was delicious, but the service was very slow.
O	Or	Use: Presents an alternative. E.g.- You can take the bus, or you can walk to the station.
Y	Yet	Use: Shows a surprising contrast. E.g.- It was a very small car, yet it was quite spacious inside.
S	So	Use: Shows result or effect. E.g.- It started to rain, so we moved the party indoors.

2. Subordinating Conjunctions

These join a dependent (subordinate) clause to an independent clause. They create Complex Sentences & define the relationship in terms of time, cause, or condition.

Category	Connectors	Example
Time	before, after, since, until,	While I was sleeping,

	while, as soon as	the phone rang.
Cause/Effect	because, since, as, so that	He failed because he didn't practice.
Condition	if, unless, provided that, even if	Unless you work hard, you won't pass.
Contrast	although, though, even though, whereas	Although it was raining, we went out.

3. Conjunctive Adverbs

These are used to connect two independent thoughts, often separated by a full stop or a semicolon.

- **Addition:** furthermore, moreover, in addition, besides.
- **Contrast:** however, nevertheless, nonetheless, on the contrary.
- **Result:** therefore, consequently, as a result, hence.
- **Sequence:** first, next, finally, subsequently.

4. Relative Pronouns

These act as connectors specifically for Adjective Clauses. They relate the clause back to a noun or pronoun mentioned earlier.

- **Who/Whom:** For people.
- **Which:** For things/animals.
- **That:** For people or things (essential information).
- **Whose:** To show possession.

E.g.- The candidate **who scores the highest marks** will be selected.

5. Correlative Conjunctions

These are pairs of connectors that work together to join similar elements. These are:- Either... or, Neither... nor, Not only... but also, Both... and, Whether... or.

E.g.- He is not only intelligent but also very hardworking.

Types of Phrases

A phrase is a group of words that functions as a single unit within a sentence. It does not contain both a subject and a verb.

Types of Phrases

Phrases are named based on the main word or the grammatical role they play in the sentence.

1. Noun Phrase : Acts as a noun in a sentence (subject or object). It includes a noun and its modifiers.

E.g.- The old, rusty gate creaked loudly.
I bought a delicious chocolate cake.

2. Verb Phrase : Consists of a main verb and its helping verbs.

E.g.- She has been studying all night.
You must follow the rules.

3. Prepositional Phrase : Starts with a preposition and ends with a noun or pronoun. It usually tells us where, when, or which.

E.g.- The book is on the table. (indicates place)
We met after the movie. (indicates time)

A prepositional phrase acts as an adjective or an adverb.

(i) As an adverb: It indicates the time, place, manner, etc.

E.g.- We took shelter under the bridge.

The phrase 'under the bridge' indicates the place where we took shelter, thus it is a prepositional phrase acting as an adverb)

(ii) As an adjective: describes a noun or a pronoun.

E.g.- The girl with the long hair is my sister.

The phrase 'with the long hair' describes the noun 'girl'. Thus, it is a prepositional phrase acting as an adjective.

4. Adjective Phrase : An adjective phrase is a phrase headed by an adjective & describes a noun or a pronoun.

E.g.- This is a task too difficult for a child.
She is an exceptionally talented artist.

An adjective phrase can appear after the noun & before the noun.

(i) Before the noun : The phrase comes immediately before the noun it describes.

E.g.- A bright metallic blue car just drove away.

The adjective phrase 'bright metallic blue' comes before the noun 'car'.

(ii) After the noun : The phrase follows a stative verb (is, am, was, look, feel).

E.g.- The dessert was unbelievably delicious.

The adjective phrase 'unbelievably delicious' comes after the noun 'dessert'.

5. Verbal Phrases (Non-finites)

These phrases are formed from verbs but act as other parts of speech.

(i)	Gerund Phrase: Starts with -ing form and acts as a noun. E.g.- <u>Swimming in the ocean</u> is my favorite hobby. 'Swimming' is a gerund and 'Swimming in the ocean' is a gerund phrase acting as a noun (Subject).
(ii)	Infinitive Phrase: Starts with 'To + V ₁ '. E.g.- I love <u>to read historical novels</u> . 'to read(V ₁)' is an infinitive, and 'to read historical novels' is an infinitive phrase acting as a noun(object).
(iii)	Participial Phrase: Starts with a participle (-ing or -ed) and acts as an adjective. E.g.- <u>Excited by the news</u> , she called her mother.
Types of Participial Phrases	
(a)	Present Participle Phrase : Starts with -ing verb. A present participle phrase is used to describe an action

	the noun is currently doing, including ongoing or permanent actions. E.g.- <u>Whistling a happy tune</u>, the mailman delivered the letters. 'Whistling' is a present participle. "Whistling a happy tune" is a present participle phrase denoting an action happening simultaneously with delivery of letters.
(b)	Past Participle Phrase : Starts with past participle form (V_3) or -ed form. The noun with a past participle phrase is receiving the action, not doing it, so the verb should be transitive. E.g.- <u>Blown by the wind</u>, the leaves scattered across the yard. 'Blown' is a past participle form(V_3). "Blown by the wind" is a past participle phrase denoting an action received by the leaves.
(c)	(c) Perfect Participle Phrase : Starts with 'Having + V_3'. It is used to show that the noun completed an action in the past, before the action of the main verb. E.g.- <u>Having typed the letter</u>, the secretary posted it. 'Having typed' is a perfect participle. "Having typed the letter" is a perfect participle phrase. The letter was typed before the secretary posted it.
Functions of an Infinitive Phrase	
(a)	As a noun : When acting as a noun, the infinitive can be the subject, object or complement. Examples:- Subject → <u>To forgive others</u> is a sign of strength. Object → The team wanted <u>to win the championship</u>. Complement → His greatest dream is <u>to travel around the world</u>.
(b)	As an adjective : It modifies a noun or pronoun. It always appears immediately after the noun it describes. E.g.- He is the right person <u>to lead this project</u>. The infinitive phrase "to lead this project" describes the noun person.
(c)	As an adverb : It modifies a verb, an adjective, or another adverb. It usually tells us why (the purpose) or provides more detail about an adjective. E.g.- She practised every day <u>to improve her skills</u>. The infinitive phrase "to improve her skills" modifies the verb 'practised'. It tells us the reason why she practised.

Parts of Speech

Parts of speech are the different categories into which words or

phrases can be divided based on their function or use in a sentence.

There are eight parts of speech.

1. **Noun** 2. **Pronoun** 3. **Adjective** 4. **Verb**
5. **Adverb** 6. **Preposition** 7. **Conjunction** 8. **Interjection**

1. Noun : A noun is a word that names a person, place, thing, action, idea, quality, state, feeling, etc.

Examples:- car (thing), Michael (person), Kolkata (place), Honesty (quality), Pleasure (feeling), knowledge (idea), freedom (state), murder (action), etc.

There are five types of nouns:

- (i) Proper Noun (ii) Common Noun (iii) Material Noun
- (iv) Collective Noun (v) Abstract Noun

(i) Proper Noun : Name of a particular person, place or thing.

Examples:- Sarah, London, Microsoft, Monday, January, Mount Everest, etc.

(ii) Common Noun : A general name for a person, place or thing.

Examples:- boy, girl, car, chair, table, day, school, etc.

(iii) Material Noun : These refer to the raw substances or materials from which things are made.

Examples:- wood, metal, iron, copper, milk, leather, etc.

(iv) Collective Noun : A group of people, animals, or things.

Examples:- colony, herd, flock, pack, pride, bunch, fleet, swarm, choir, crew, deck, bouquet, etc.

(v) Abstract Noun : An abstract noun denotes a feeling, quality, idea, state or action.

Examples:- joy (feeling), honesty (quality), justice (idea), information (idea), freedom (state), slavery (state), execution (action), delivery (action), etc.

2. Pronouns : A word used in place of a noun to avoid repetition.

Pronoun	Examples
Personal	Subjective → I, we, you, he, she, it, they
	Objective → me, us, you, him, her, it, them
Indefinite	Nothing, something, anything, everything, Nobody, somebody, anybody, everybody, No one, someone, anyone, everyone,
Possessive	mine, ours, yours, his, hers, theirs
Reflexive	Myself, ourselves, yourself, yourselves, himself, herself, itself, themselves
Demonstrative	This, that, these, those

Interrogative (used at the beginning of an interrogative sentence)	Who, whom, which, whose, what
Relative (used to form relative clauses)	Who, whom, whose, which, that
Reciprocal	each other, one another
Distributive	Each, any, none, either, neither

Classification of Personal Pronouns

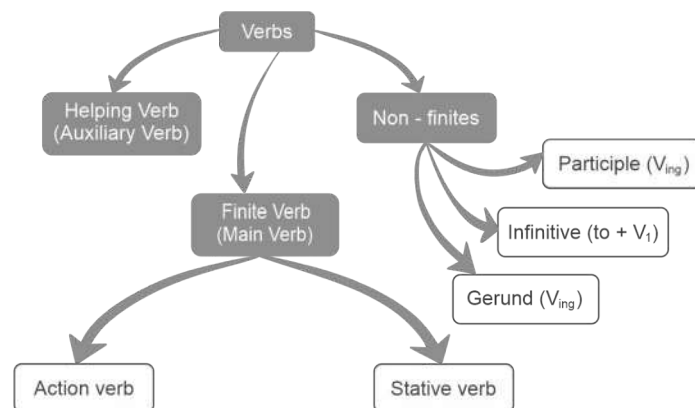
Person	Case	Singular	Plural
First	Subjective	I	We
	Objective	me	us
Second	Subjective	-	You
	Objective	-	you
Third	Subjective	He/She/It	They
	Objective	him/her/it	them

3. Adjective : Adjectives are the words used to describe nouns or pronouns.

Adjective	Examples
Descriptive (Qualitative) (Used to describe the quality of a person, place or thing)	beautiful, tall, blue, happy, miserable, etc
Quantitative (Tell us about the quantity of a noun)	some, any, few, little, many, much, several, enough, all, no, plenty, one, two, ten, first, second, thirty, hundred, half, quarter, etc.
Demonstrative (Used to point out something specific)	this, that, these, those
Possessive (used to show possession, ownership or relationship)	my, our, your, his, her, its, their
Interrogative (Used to ask a question)	which, whose, what
Relative (Used to form noun-clause)	which, what, whichever, whatever
Distributive (refers to members of a group individually)	each, every, either, neither, any
Proper (denoting Nationality)	Indian, American, Japanese, Russian, Chinese, French, etc.

4. Verb : A verb shows an action, occurrence or a state of being.

Examples:- run, dance, fly, happen, occur, is, exist, become, etc.



(i) Finite Verb : It is the main verb in a sentence that shows the action, state or condition of the subject.

Action Verbs : Verbs that denote an action.
For example:- jump, sing, dance, fly, write, etc.

Stative Verbs : Verbs that denote a state or condition.
Examples:- is, am, are, was, were, look, feel, own, possess, have, taste, know, think, believe, understand, cost, weigh, measure, etc.

(ii) Helping Verb : A verb that comes with the main verb to clarify tense, mood, or voice in a sentence.

Classification of Helping Verbs

Singular	Plural	Modal
does / is / am / was / has	do / are / were / have	will, shall, can, may, could, might, would, should, must, etc.

(iii) Non-finites : Verbs that do not show tense, person, or number. These verbs act as a noun, adjective or an adverb.

Examples:-

She wanted to eat pizza. (Infinitive)

Running is good for your health. (Gerund)

The crying baby needed food. (Participle)

5. Adverb : An adverb is a word that modifies a verb, adjective or another adverb.

Type	Examples
Adverb of manner (tells us how something is done)	quickly, slowly, carefully, loudly, softly, happily, etc.
Adverb of time (tells the time)	Now, yesterday, tomorrow, soon, later, etc.
Adverb of place (tells us the place)	here, there, ahead, abroad, outside, inside, away, etc.
Adverb of Frequency (how frequently something happens)	often, always, seldom, never, frequently, rarely, etc.
Adverb of degree (tells us about the intensity or extent of the action/quality)	Very, quite, too, extremely, almost, entirely, etc.